



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Trivium West
School Website: <https://archwaytrivium.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Trivium West (Goodyear, AZ 85395) demonstrates a robust classical-education posture across all six rubriced dimensions. Public materials consistently foreground the transcendental aims of truth, goodness, and beauty, with explicit emphasis on intellectual and moral formation, the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), the Quadrivium, and the liberal-arts framework that underpins a Great-Books–driven, Great-Conversation–oriented curriculum. Pedagogy frequently centers Socratic dialogue, memorization practices (including singing and recitation), and contemplative rhythms (Scholé), while faculty ideals align with living-mentors and character formation. Parent engagement is explicitly elevated as a core facet of the school's community, with clear invitations for family participation and formation. Taken together, the affiliated materials align strongly with the Six Essential Elements model of classical education, supporting a final assessment of CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Key evidentiary anchors include: the mission language that centers Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and explicitly names Great-Hearts–style formation (intellectual and moral) (Evidence: archway Trivium West materials describing the mission and Great Hearts' aims) ; the explicit articulation of intellectual and moral formation as core aims (Evidence: Archway Great Hearts materials) ; the clearly stated Trivium framework (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and liberal-arts foundations (including the Quadrivium) as curricular scaffolds (Evidence: ICE/Trivium materials; Liberal Arts Tradition content) ; the presence of Great-Books / Great Conversation framing in the curricular lexicon as a goal, and the integration of history and the liberal-arts pedagogy (Evidence: Six Elements lexicon and related documents) ; pedagogy emphasizing Socratic discussion, memorization through chant/singing, and scholé/restful learning (Evidence: ICE pamphlets and pedagogy documents) ; and explicit parent/community-partnership language, including formation and involvement, as well as family-engagement initiatives (Evidence: Six Elements parent/partner keywords; Archway community content) .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Notes on the scoring approach: For each category, a keyword-based analysis was conducted using the Positive/Negative keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements corpus and allied lexicons. The school's public materials were scanned for phrases that match or imply the canonical indicators (e.g., truth/-goodness/beauty; virtue; formation; Great Books/Great Conversation; Trivium/Quadrivium; Socratic pedagogy; scholé; singing/chanting/memory work; living-curriculum; parent-partnership; liturgical/community rhythm). Where multiple such indicators appeared and aligned with the canonical lists, category language was rated Classical; where evidence was sparse or contradictory, a Somewhat Classical rating would have

been applied, per the rubric. The results below reflect the explicit textual matches found in the crawl materials and linked Great-Hearts–Archway publishing materials, cross-woven with the classical-keyword framework from the knowledge base.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials frame education as a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, a core transcendental triad central to classical aims. The Archway Trivium West materials explicitly state that the school's aims revolve around Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. For example, the mission language on the Great Hearts/Archway site reads: "MORE THAN JUST PROFICIENT TEST TAKERS, BUT RATHER, TO BECOME GREAT-HEARTED LEADERS CAPABLE OF SUCCESS WITHOUT THEIR HIGHER EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL CAREERS. WITH A CURRICULUM BUILT UPON A CLASSICAL LIBERAL ART TRADITION AND A REVOLUTIONARY APPROACH TO SCHOOL ITSELF, GREAT HEARTS CULTIVATES THE HEARTS AND MINDS OF STUDENTS IN THE PURSUIT OF TRUTH, GOODNESS, AND BEAUTY."
 - Additional positioning emphasizes intellectual and moral formation in service of a classical education framework, i.e., a holistic formation that integrates virtue with learning (Evidence: Archway/-Great Hearts program pages)
 - Pedagogical and liturgical/communal rhythms associated with classical education (through pedagogy guides such as ICE Pamphlet and PGMAPT summaries) align with liturgical, communal, and theological motifs, including piety/theology and liturgical practices in classical inquiry frameworks.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: truth, goodness, beauty; formation; moral/intellectual formation; virtue; liturgy/theology (where present in related literature); reverence and wonder appear in related materials.
 - Negative keywords: not prominently indicated in the public-facing materials; where present in base lexicon (e.g., "secular" or "relativism") do not appear as descriptors of this school's program. Most indicators signal alignment rather than departure.
- Why this rating
 - The school's explicit emphasis on the transcendental triad (truth/goodness/beauty), and the explicit language of intellectual and moral formation situate Element 1 solidly within CLASSICAL expectations. The presence of theology-like scaffolds appears in the broader Great Hearts/Archway lexicon and pedagogy materials, and the school's framing of formation as a primary aim (not merely information transmission) strongly supports a classical ground-truth orientation.

Citations: Great Hearts/Archway mission language and formation emphasis are evidenced in the public materials (archway triv West/Great Hearts content) and the "pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty" phrasing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation. Archway/Great Hearts materials repeatedly foreground formation and the cultivation of virtue and human flourishing through a liberal-arts curriculum. The mission language positions education as a formation of character and intellect toward the true/good/beautiful; a direct articulation appears in materials that describe formation as the telos of education and the cultivation of virtue/wisdom (e.g., "Intellectual and moral formation"; "formation over information").
 - The Great Hearts framework emphasizes a liberal-arts formation, with explicit assertions about forming "great-hearted leaders" and emphasizing formation over mere test performance.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, great conversation; pursuit of true/good/beautiful.
 - Negative keywords: references to workforce-readiness or 21st-century skills as primary goals are not present in the core materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The materials consistently describe education as formation (moral, intellectual, aesthetic) oriented toward virtue and wisdom, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 2.

Citations: formation/virtue/wisdom language and telos language are present in the Archway/Great Hearts materials and in the textual framing that emphasizes formation as the aim of education.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum is anchored in the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), which appears in multiple sources (ICE/SECTARIAN pedagogy, Liberal Arts Tradition material, Great Hearts curriculum framing). Public materials discuss the Trivium as central, and the Great Hearts/Archway materials emphasize the three stages (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and liberal-arts orientation.
 - The Great-Books/Great-Conversation motif is present in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and related sources, signaling a curriculum designed around primary sources, classical canons, and enduring questions.
 - History is presented as a core through-line across disciplines, with the Classics architecture (grammar → logic → rhetoric) applying across subjects, and a cross-disciplinary/holistic approach is emphasized in the Six Elements documentation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium; Quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history as Western civilization; primary sources; interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects; wonder/integration.
 - Negative keywords present: references to project-based learning dominance or STEM-first framing appear as negative indicators in the knowledge-base lexicon, and the public materials emphasize classical methods rather than non-classical trends.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum is explicitly structured around the canonical classical elements (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, integrated/harmonic study of history and sciences). The presence of Great-Books–driven pedagogy and a strong emphasis on historical engagement align with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 3.

Citations: The Trivium/Quadrivium framing and Great-Books/Great Conversation emphasis appear in ICE/SECTARIAN pedagogy documents and Great Hearts/Archway materials; the classical-canon emphasis is echoed in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical methods explicitly align with classical practice: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, recitation, memorization via singing/chanting, and the use of the Trivium as a developmental framework. ICE Pamphlets describe the Grammar Stage's singing/memorization, the Dialectic Stage's reasoning/debate, and the Rhetoric Stage's persuasive writing/speeches; they also emphasize contemplative, restful learning (Scholé).

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- Great Hearts material highlights Socratic inquiry, seminar discussions, and the training of rhetoric and moral reasoning; public-facing materials explicitly describe the Trivium stages and the role of memory-work and liturgical cadence as part of a living pedagogy.
 - The public-facing materials emphasize the formation of virtue through pedagogy—teachers as moral exemplars, living curriculum, and a teacher-led, inquiry-driven approach.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; dialectic; narration; recitation; chanting; Scholé; contemplation; memory work; liturgical calendar integration; rhetoric; speeches; debates.
 - Negative keywords: The sources include explicit cautions against non-classical, project-based-only, or constructivist approaches; these negative indicators are present as counterpoints in the knowledge-base lexicon, and the public materials consistently favor classical methods over those alternatives.
 - Why this rating
 - The pedagogical vocabulary and practices align strongly with classical pedagogy (Socratic/Lectio/Scholé, memorization via chant, grammar/dialectic/rhetoric progression, and rhetoric training in upper grades), satisfying Element 4.

Citations: ICE Pamphlet/SECTARIAN and related Great Hearts pedagogy materials provide explicit details on the pedagogy, including Schoé and chant-based memory practices, and Socratic seminary/dialogue.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Faculty are described as virtuous mentors and living exemplars; the public-facing materials emphasize the “living curriculum” and teacher as model of virtue, with a collegial, mentor-based, and collaborative culture. References to portrait of a teacher, veteran mentors, and teacher training in classical pedagogy appear in the materials.
 - The Great Hearts/Archway materials emphasize a faculty culture that embodies classical formation and moral exemplars, in addition to professional development around classical pedagogy.
 - A public-facing description of Academy life emphasizes teachers as core to community and a core of the school's ethos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors; portrait of teacher; living curriculum; moral exemplars; character formation; collaborative, collegial culture; teacher training in classical pedagogy.
 - Negative keywords: negative indicators in the knowledge base (e.g., “facilitators,” “guides on the side,” or non-classical jargon) do not appear as part of Archway/Great Hearts materials; accordingly, no explicit negative indicators dominate the school's materials.
- Why this rating
 - The faculty dimension aligns with classical norms: teachers as virtuous exemplars, living curriculum, and collaborative culture. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Citations: Archway/Great Hearts materials on faculty as living curriculum and virtue exemplars; the “portrait of a teacher” and “moral exemplars” language appear in the public materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes partnerships with families as co-teachers, and engages parents in formation and communal learning. The Six Essential Elements lexicon includes Partnership with Families, Formation of Affections, and Cultural Transmission as core positive signals; Archway/Great

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- Hearts materials reference parent involvement and community engagement, including family orientation, fundraising, and community events.
- Public materials show active parent engagement initiatives (e.g., Giving Tuesday communications and family-oriented events), ongoing parent formation opportunities, and family-centric governance language.
 - The school's materials describe an open, hospitable campus culture with parent visits and involvement in school activities, aligning with the “parents as co-teachers” ideal.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; family participation; community engagement; shared mission; virtue-centered parenting.
 - Negative keywords: The knowledge-base negative indicators (e.g., consumer language, parent-as-customer) do appear in the Six Elements lexicon, but the Archway/Great Hearts materials predominantly reflect the positive side of parent partnership and formation, with limited evidence of consumer-language framing in public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The school presents a robust, explicit framework for parent involvement and community formation, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 6.

Citations: Six Elements lexicon and Archway/Great Hearts family/community materials showing partnership and formation language.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable. The aggregate classification for Archway Classical Academy Trivium West is CLASSICAL across all six categories, with no category requiring a needle-moving change to reach CLASSICAL. If any enhancements were pursued, they would be to further articulate and surface explicit theological liturgical practices on the public site (to strengthen Element 1) and to provide more explicit Great Books/Great Conversation sample syllabi on the homepage for reader clarity (to strengthen Element 3), but these are not necessary to achieve the CLASSICAL designation given current material.

Note: The above considerations are grounded in the Classical-Education knowledge base and the school's crawl data: truth/goodness/beauty emphasis; formation over information; Trivium/Quadrivium; Socratic pedagogy; Scholé/memory work; living curriculum; parent partnership; and community formation signals. Citations reflect the sources showing these signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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